

Lititz BMX: Fireside Chat Podcast Plan

Host: Kyle A. Huffman

Guest: Damian Fulton

Recording Date: _____TBD_____

Table of Contents

- Introduction
- A little about Kyle
- Conversation Outline
- Potential Questions
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- Connecting and Recording
- Conclusion
- Podcast Guest Release Form
- Notes

Introduction

Thank you for considering being a guest on my podcast. This podcast grew from a lack of an outlet for a retired Instructional Designer, Veteran, and BMX enthusiast. Really, the perfect storm as you will most likely learn soon.

So, here is the lead-up timeline:

- Aug 2024: I purchased a Radical Rick trophy (plaque) on eBay, for my RR collection, and asked the seller who earned it. I was told “I purchased Harry Leary’s storage unit last year”. I looked around and on faith bought a few more items before buying my first “lot” from the seller.

I shared that purchases were made, with the seller by name, in two facebook groups and was met with crickets (August 24th). Noone cared. I was told it was a “fool's investment” and laughed at or ignored. I have purchased four lots now and plan on purchasing more as the opportunity arises; the seller and I have developed a friendship. I don’t know what he has in inventory, I am going mostly on blind faith when available.

- Suddenly, starting September 7th, everyone cared but I was asked not to participate in other groups and respectfully withdrew.
- So, I started The Unofficial Harry Leary Fireside Chat Group on Facebook and began developing content to support the page, with goals of:
1) enhancing my understanding of my own collection, 2) giving myself a “retired professional” outlet (creativity not financial), and 3) developing and nurturing a living Harry Leary Body of Knowledge that includes open discussions, perhaps a place to work through grief of his passing and many issues created during his life, and public validation and verification of Harry Leary items.

This podcast is the next step in the evolution of this program.

Notes:

A Little About Kyle

Kyle is a late 70's baby and has all of the likes and quirks of one who grew up in The SF East Bay during that time frame. Like most of his generation, he's kind of a hodgepodge of eclectic stirrings. But, there are those who love him regardless.

So... Here are:

Five "Interesting" Facts

- 1) He has hired over 1000 people and even developed an employment path for "unqualified" candidates that had a good personality, as a Silicon Valley tech company direct hiring manager during high growth pre and post IPO periods. This team went on to earn SC Magazine Awards 3 of his 4 years for "Industry Best Customer Service".
- 2) Kyle inherited a pet piranha.
- 3) His collection of 13 BMX bikes and fun memorabilia has him wanting to open a museum eventually - *"I'm a "retired" Instructional Designer and one of my Master Degrees is in Education with a focus on Online Teaching & Learning so it is the perfect retirement job."*
- 4) He is the son of a former Hells Angel who went to prison when Kyle was two years old.
- 5) He founded the Veterans Employee Resource Group (VERG) for a major financial institution and within 3 years the group earned a Secretary of Defense Employer Support Freedom Award.
- 6) He had his first daughter at the age of 44. She is the blessing of his life and he is grateful that he is able to be a Stay-at-Home Dad with her. Their current thing is Ms. Rachel.

You said five - Oh, you caught that...

He is a 100% VA Disabled Veteran who deployed twice onboard the USS Oldendorf (DD-972), earned the designator of Master Training Specialist (MTS) while stationed at the Naval Security Group Activity (NSGA)/Cryptologic Readiness Group (CRG), and served as a Senior Consultant: Cryptologic Intelligence Collection Operations at the Space and Naval Warfare Command (SPAWAR) - Under NSA tasking & is a "451" graduate (Intermediate Signal Analyst).

Ok, so... LinkedIn stuff over. I've done a lot but I have my demons. I have over 6 years of sobriety from alcohol. Shortly after quitting drinking, I discovered I was Bi-Polar 1 - the fight of my life began. It's a long story that nearly cost me everything, hell - I nearly threw it all away. Nearly...

My Story finds hope



Conversation Outline

Setting the stage:

This podcast draws inspiration from many hours as a kid spent listening to cassettes of old radio programs - where you had to use a bit of imagination but the stories were amazing. Throw in content awareness from Howard Stern and you have the show's core foundation. It pairs that with a stage that draws inspiration from the Facebook group's fireside chat theme. This podcast's theme will be based on a fireside chat held at a bonfire at the beach, with background audio that includes soundtracks of the beach and a fire. It is unknown if a visual will be used at this time - this decision will likely come during the editing or review process but may include: images, video recordings of the conversation, a muted (opacity) fire video, and more.

Think of this as a limited visual movie experience disguised as an interview.

Introduction: "Hello"

I don't believe listeners should be subjected to a long over produced intro that does nothing to actually enhance the content. So, this podcast will provide a brief introduction consisting of: 1) ocean bonfire background audio (throughout), 2) a bicycle pulling up and someone dismounting, 3) footsteps, then 4) brief greetings. That's it.

Think - You just rode up to a bonfire and say "Hi Kyle"

I respond with "Hey Damian"

We share greetings

What's new? Do you have anything exciting coming up?

Why yes, in fact I am ... you?

...

Body: "Hey, I was wondering ..."

- Questions about Harry
- Non-Harry Questions
- Final questions and words from Damian

Conclusion: Till next times...

Potential Questions (Base)

Harry Related:

- When we first talked, you mentioned doing work for Diamond Back back in the day. Would you mind expanding on that and did any of it involve Harry Leary?
 - How long did you work with Diamond Back, when to when, and what projects did you work on?
 - What was your working relationship like with Harry (it's ok if it was negative)?
 - I've gotten the impression that Harry had a very business capable mind, simply based on interviews I've listened to. Would you agree and can you tell us a story about why?
 - Did you two ever engage outside of work and if so, what was he like as just Harry the guy?
 - One thing that would shock listeners to know about Harry that is most likely not in the public domain (positive preferably).
- We also briefly discussed redemption and I let you know about the quote unquote elbow incident. You said "Was Harry up to his old ways?" What did you mean by his "old ways" - from your perspective? Good, Bad, or Indifferent
- In an interview you mentioned, "don't ever meet your heroes." Many people have reached out and expressed anger about Harry for many things he did or didn't do. In this post mortem phase we are in for Harry, as someone notable from the era, what could you say to his current or former friends, associates, or fans that may offer some sense of redemption or peace.
- First word to come to mind when you think of Harry as (anything is fair game):
 - Coworker:
 - Friend:
 - Business Associate:
 - BMX Legend:
 - Why did you choose those words?

- You've done a charity event with the Facebook Group "The Unofficial Harry Leary Fireside Chat Group."

How did you get involved with the group and what do you think of their Facebook Group and its content?

Do you think that the charity work they are doing is inline with what Harry would have wanted from a "Pay-it-Forward" perspective?

Do you in any way think it disrespects Harry and/or his memory? Would his family find honor in it?

- Final words: Is there anything you would like to say about Harry, or to his friends and family?

Non-Harry Related:

- Before we dive into a few non-Harry related questions, did I hear that you worked for Hot Wheels?

- What did you do for Hot Wheels?

- What was the coolest project you worked on at Hot Wheels - the one you most remember?

- When we first talked, you mentioned liking kids on e-bikes, e-scooters etc.:

- State your case for the use of electronic sporting devices like e-scooter or e-bikes.

- Is there a place for eBMX within the sport of BMX?

- Will society be able to find a hybrid or separate approach to potential eBMX and the sport as we know it, or as a sport in and of itself?

- When your kids were growing up, what did they love to watch that you hated!

- What was your favorite thing to cook for your kids when they were young?

- What is a family tradition of yours during Christmas time that other people might think is weird?

- I've heard you mention BMX Plus wanting a cartoon, even though you wanted to be a serious artist. Radical Rick became what it became but BMX Plus "tried" other cartoon options.
For example:

- Bob Haro apparently liked to draw and drew an ET picture for the magazine.
- Frank Attoman (?) drawing in January 1979 - One year before Radical Rick dropped.

* Why didn't Bob Haro draw more, or did he and I am just ignorant? It also seems fitting that you have a Haro edition series of bikes.

* Do you know Frank and what became of him?

* How many other comics did they go through until they found you and Radical Rick (published or unpublished) - or was the other stuff just coincidence?

Radical Rick Related Questions:

- From your Paperback's Introduction: There has been a lot of discussion about mental health in our group. I have shared my struggles with being Bi-Polar and other members have shared theirs as well. I believe Harry had undiagnosed or diagnosed mental health issues or CTE - I have no basis for this belief other than my own opinion. But, it has become a focal point in what I think is a big part of the group, at least the potential, and a needed outlet for many as has been expressed publicly and privately.

In your paperback, I don't own the hard bound copy, you have an introduction that discusses something near and dear to my heart - mental health. I have actually written an [article](#) about this, my experience, so I appreciate seeing others who freely share their mental health struggles.

- Have you been open with readers about your struggles with anxiety before and I just never realized, or is this new? This was something that caught me off guard, in the most refreshing of ways.
 - Why did you share this?
- What is your advice for someone who is struggling with mental health issues (maybe even minor) and on the fence about seeking professional help?
- What is your best advice for someone trying to recover from a mental health disaster, post event?

- Did Mr. T. ever get upset about being turned into your Mr. Tea? What happened?

- How did you know it was time to “end” the Radical Rick run in BMX Plus?

- Why am I to believe that the series is truly over? They never recovered a body or bike fragments for that matter. How do we know his excessive rad gland didn’t protect him from the blast, or some other fluke? Rick Grimes came back.

- Will there be a “final” episode of Radical Rick?

- Would you consider developing a parallel universe Radical Rick short-run print series and what would it look like? Perhaps a darker story? Perhaps with Radical Rick as the villain?

- Cast of Characters: I’ve heard there has been talk of making a Radical Rick cartoon or movie over the years. The downfall has been “interest decay”. That said, you can choose any actor/actress from past or present to play characters in Radical Rick the Live Action Movie. Who do you choose for:

Radical Rick:

Morton X. “MX” Mug:

Skuzzer Switchblade:

Bonnie Brainstorm:

Captain Crank:

Spike Speedwrench:

Butch Cartilage:

Miss Wristwack:

Notes:

Connecting and Recording

Facebook Messenger Video will be the primary service to connect, unless otherwise requested.

Alternates may include: Zoom, phone call on speaker, or other options agreed to by all parties.

Recording tools to be used include, but are not limited to: Camtasia screen recording and/or other digital recording devices to capture, edit, host, and disseminate audio and/or video.

The great thing about being an audio focused podcast is that we have the liberty of editing pretty easy. I can easily:

- Clear-up most "Um's" "Ah's" "Uh's" etc. Even a cough. I just ask that you think to leave me a buffer to clean things up - just a brief moment if you can.
- If you make an error, or misspeak, don't like how something came out, or your wife opens the door and asks for you to pick up milk... It is ok, we can pause and you can reframe your thoughts and I will edit accordingly.

Please make sure you are in as quiet of a room as possible - life happens but driving down the 5 with the top down does not make for a good recording - I am sure you are aware. I'll probably have my daughter, so - professional, I know. The power of editing.

Conclusion

Thank you. I look forward to hearing back from you.

Podcast Guest Release Form

Podcast Name: Fireside Chat (Kyle A. Huffman)

Guest Name: Damian Fulton

****1. Permission to Record and Use Likeness****

I, Damian Fulton, hereby grant Fireside Chat permission to record my voice, likeness, and any other personal information shared during the podcast episode. I understand that this recording will be used for the podcast titled Fireside Chat: Damian Fulton, which will be publicly available.

****2. Grant of Rights****

I grant Fireside Chat the right to use, reproduce, distribute, and publicly display the recording, including but not limited to the podcast episode, promotional materials, and any other media, both now and in the future. I understand that Fireside Chat may edit, alter, or otherwise modify the recording as necessary.

****3. Waiver of Rights****

I waive any right to inspect or approve the finished product or the use to which it may be applied. I acknowledge that Fireside Chat will not be liable for any claims arising from the use of the recording, including but not limited to defamation, invasion of privacy, or infringement of any rights.

****4. Compensation****

I understand that I will not receive any compensation for participating in the podcast or for the use of the recording.

****5. Indemnity****

I agree to indemnify and hold harmless Fireside Chat, its employees, and its agents from any and all claims, liabilities, damages, and expenses arising from the use of the recording as described herein.

****6. Agreement****

By signing below, I acknowledge that I have read and understood this release form, and I agree to the terms and conditions set forth above.

****Signature:**** _____

****Date:**** _____

****Guest Contact Information:****

****Email:**** _____

****Phone:**** _____

*Please fill out and sign this form, then send a picture of it via text to Kyle's cell:
Or Scan and email it to

[illegible]